2025－2026 学年第二学期
《学术英语读写》 课程论文

日期：2026 年 6 月 17 日　　得分

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学术英语读写
Academic English Reading and Writing

Task：Write an Introduction of your research based on the outline given. The Introduction should include the following parts:
1. Lead-in the topic and introduce the background information.
2. Review on the previous studies and point out their limitations.
3. State the purpose of your study or raise the research questions.
4. Briefly introduce the methods you are going to apply in your research.
5. Write a reference list of all the sources you have cited.

Requirements:
1. 400-500 words.
2. Deadline: Week 16
3. Print on both sides
4. Typeface: Times New Roman. Font size: 12. Double-spaced.
5. Reference sample:
   Newton, I. (2025). Title of the Source. The Publishing House/The Journal.

Title:

The Relationship between Social Media Use and Anxiety among Undergraduate Students in NPU.

Introduction:

In recent years, social media has become an important part of university students' daily life. Platforms such as WeChat, QQ, Weibo, Douyin, Xiaohongshu, and Bilibili are widely used for communication, entertainment, information searching, and academic cooperation. For undergraduate students, social media provides convenience and social connection, but excessive or uncontrolled use may also bring psychological pressure. Anxiety, which refers to a state of worry, nervousness, or fear about uncertain events, is one of the common mental health problems

among college students. Since university students often face academic pressure, career uncertainty, peer comparison, and social relationship challenges, the relationship between social media use and anxiety deserves closer attention.

Previous studies have examined the connection between social media use and mental health. Keles, McCrae, and Grealish (2020) found that time spent on social media, repeated checking, emotional investment, and problematic use were related to depression, anxiety, and psychological distress. Vannucci, Flannery, and Ohannessian (2017) also reported that social media use was associated with anxiety symptoms among emerging adults. In addition, Primack et al. (2017) found that young adults with higher social media use tended to report stronger perceived social isolation, which may indirectly influence anxiety. Hunt et al. (2018) further suggested that reducing social media use may improve certain aspects of psychological well-being.

However, existing studies still have several limitations. First, many studies focus on Western populations, while fewer studies examine Chinese undergraduate students in a specific university context. Second, previous research often measures total social media use time, but daily usage patterns, such as frequency of checking, night-time use, and academic versus entertainment use, may also be important. Third, the specific relationship between daily social media use and anxiety levels among undergraduate students at Northwestern Polytechnical University has not been sufficiently explored. Therefore, a more focused investigation is needed.

The purpose of this study is to examine how daily social media usage is associated with anxiety levels among undergraduate students at Northwestern Polytechnical University. The main research question is: How does daily social media usage affect anxiety levels among undergraduate students in NPU? More specifically, this study will explore whether longer daily use, frequent checking, and night-time social media use are related to higher anxiety levels. Since this study is based on a questionnaire survey, it will mainly identify associations rather than prove a direct causal relationship.

This study will use a quantitative survey method. Undergraduate students at NPU will be invited to complete an anonymous questionnaire. The questionnaire will include questions about average daily social media use time, commonly used platforms, frequency of checking social media, main purposes of use, and night-time usage habits. Anxiety levels will be measured with reference to the Generalized Anxiety Disorder Scale, also known as GAD-7, a widely used screening tool for anxiety symptoms (Spitzer et al., 2006). After data collection, the relationship between social media use and anxiety scores will be analyzed. The findings may help improve understanding of students' digital habits and provide useful evidence for mental health education and student support services on campus.

References：

[1] Hunt, M. G., Marx, R., Lipson, C., & Young, J. (2018). No More FOMO: Limiting Social Media Decreases Loneliness and Depression. Journal of Social and Clinical Psychology.

[2] Keles, B., McCrae, N., & Grealish, A. (2020). A Systematic Review: The Influence of Social Media on Depression, Anxiety and Psychological Distress in Adolescents. International Journal of Adolescence and Youth.

[3] Primack, B. A., Shensa, A., Sidani, J. E., Whaite, E. O., Lin, L. Y., Rosen, D., Colditz, J. B., Radovic, A., & Miller, E. (2017). Social Media Use and Perceived Social Isolation among Young Adults in the U.S. American Journal of Preventive Medicine.

[4] Spitzer, R. L., Kroenke, K., Williams, J. B. W., & Löwe, B. (2006). A Brief Measure for Assessing Generalized Anxiety Disorder: The GAD-7. Archives of Internal Medicine.

[5] Vannucci, A., Flannery, K. M., & Ohannessian, C. M. (2017). Social Media Use and Anxiety in Emerging Adults. Journal of Affective Disorders.